Police Worry About New Limits on Chinese Drones

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Many police departments in the United States use **drones**. **Drones** are small flying machines with cameras. Police use them to search for lost people, look at crashes and watch big crowds. About 6,000 police **agencies** have **drones**.

Most of these **drones** are made by DJI, a company in China. The Trump **administration** wants Americans to buy **drones** made in the U.S. It has banned many new **foreign drones** and added extra taxes on some others. The government says Chinese **drones** could be a safety risk. DJI says that is not true.

In Ocean County, New Jersey, police used a drone in July to drop floats to two swimmers in trouble. Both were brought safely to shore. The leader of the drone team, Kevin Fennessy, says American **drones** are good but cost about three times as much.

Some states have banned police from using **foreign drones**. Fennessy says if police must switch, "the **funding**'s got to be there."

Word Treasure

drones -- Small flying machines with no pilot inside, often with cameras.
agencies -- Groups or offices that do a certain job, like police departments.
foreign -- From another country.
administration -- The president and the team that runs the government.
funding -- Money given to pay for something.

Background you need

Police use drones to search for lost people and help with rescues.

Many drones are made in China because they work well and cost less.

The U.S. government wants more drones to be made in America.

Break it down

WHO: The Trump administration, police departments and the Chinese company DJI
WHAT: New limits on Chinese drones make them harder and costlier for police to get
WHERE: Police departments across the United States, including Ocean County, New Jersey
WHY: The government says Chinese drones could be a safety risk and wants more drones made in America

Why it matters

Drones help police find lost people and rescue swimmers, so these rules can affect how safe communities are.

Test what you remember

1. What are drones?

(A) Phones
(B) Boats
(C) Police cars
(D) Small flying machines with cameras

2. About how many police agencies have drones?

(A) About 60
(B) About 6
(C) About 6,000
(D) About 600,000

3. Where is the company DJI from?

(A) Canada
(B) New Jersey
(C) China
(D) Mexico

4. How did Ocean County police use a drone in July?

(A) To win a race
(B) To paint a wall
(C) To deliver pizza
(D) To drop floats to two swimmers

5. About how much more do American drones cost, says Fennessy?

(A) Half as much
(B) The same
(C) About three times as much
(D) Ten cents more

6. What does the government say about Chinese drones?

(A) They could be a safety risk
(B) They are too small
(C) They are too slow
(D) They cannot fly

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: C 4: D 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **The government: Says Chinese drones could be a safety risk.**
2. **DJI: Says that is not true.**
3. **Kevin Fennessy: Says American drones cost more, so police need money to switch.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):